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AI Transparency, Plagiarism & Originality: A Complete Guide for Academics

March 19, 2026

The AI Exchange

Real Conversations on AI in Education and Research

AI Literacy for Academics

A dedicated series on responsible, effective AI use specifically designed for academic researchers and students.

Our Vision

AI that brings out the best in you.
Empowering academics, from first idea to final draft, whilst preserving integrity and authorship.

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Professor Emmanuel Tsekleves
Lancaster University

Nolita Coelho
Vice President, Product

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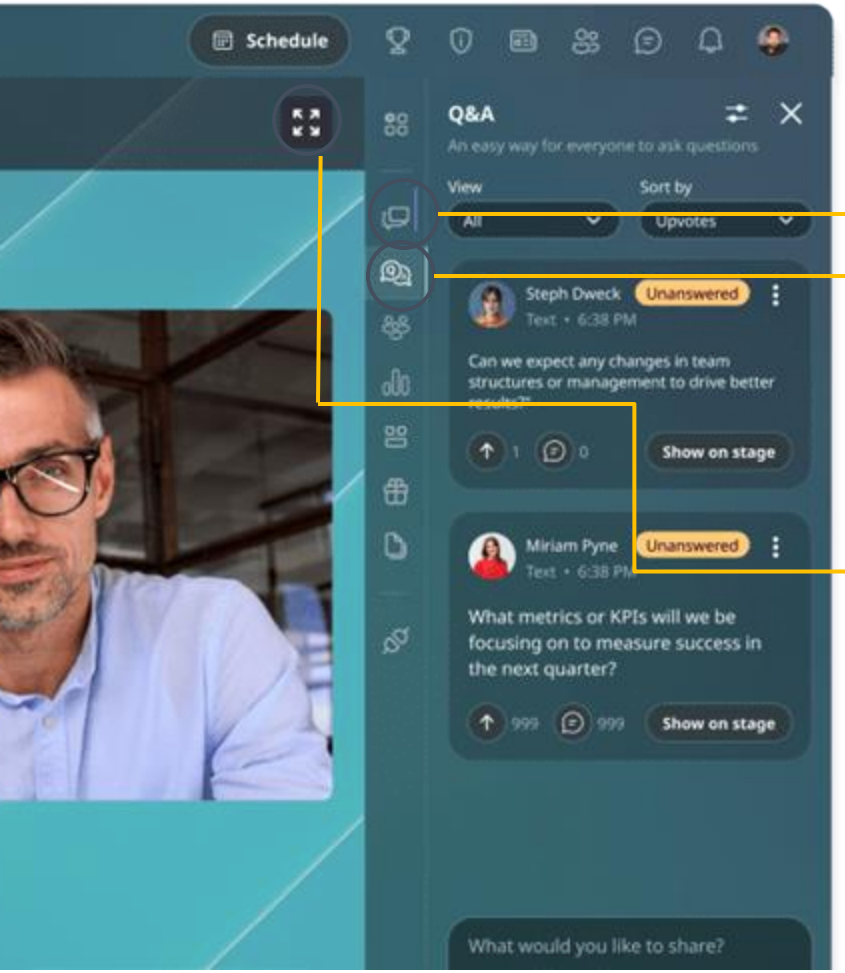

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Chat window: Be active, engage, share experiences

Q&A window: Have questions? Add it to Q&A, not in chat!

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After the session:

Demo recording & resources will be emailed to you soon!

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What to expect from this session

- **Distinguish between ethical AI assistance and academic misconduct** in academic writing, understanding where to draw the line.
- **Apply transparency best practices** including when and how to disclose AI use to meet publisher and institutional requirements.
- **Maintain originality and avoid plagiarism** while leveraging AI tools for academic productivity.
- **Implement practical strategies** for responsible AI use throughout their research and writing workflow.

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Setting context

Reality check

- AI tools are widely used, the question is not if but how, academic community's evolving stance on AI, why transparency matters more than prohibition

Publisher and Institutional Perspectives

- Major publishers (Elsevier, Springer Nature, Wiley) now require AI disclosure, not prohibition
- COPE guidelines: AI cannot be listed as an author, but its use must be transparently reported
- Unis are shifting from "ban AI" to "regulate and disclose AI use"

Academic integrity in the Age of AI

- Academic integrity isn't about avoiding AI; it's about honest scholarship
- The core principle remains unchanged: your ideas, your analysis, your voice
- AI should assist the process, never replace the researcher's critical thinking

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Understanding the boundaries

Spectrum of AI use

Generally acceptable uses, grey areas, unacceptable use

The Golden Rule

If AI contributed to your work, disclose it

Transparency best practices

How to disclose AI use, publisher-specific requirements, what to do when you're in doubt

AI Disclosure Templates

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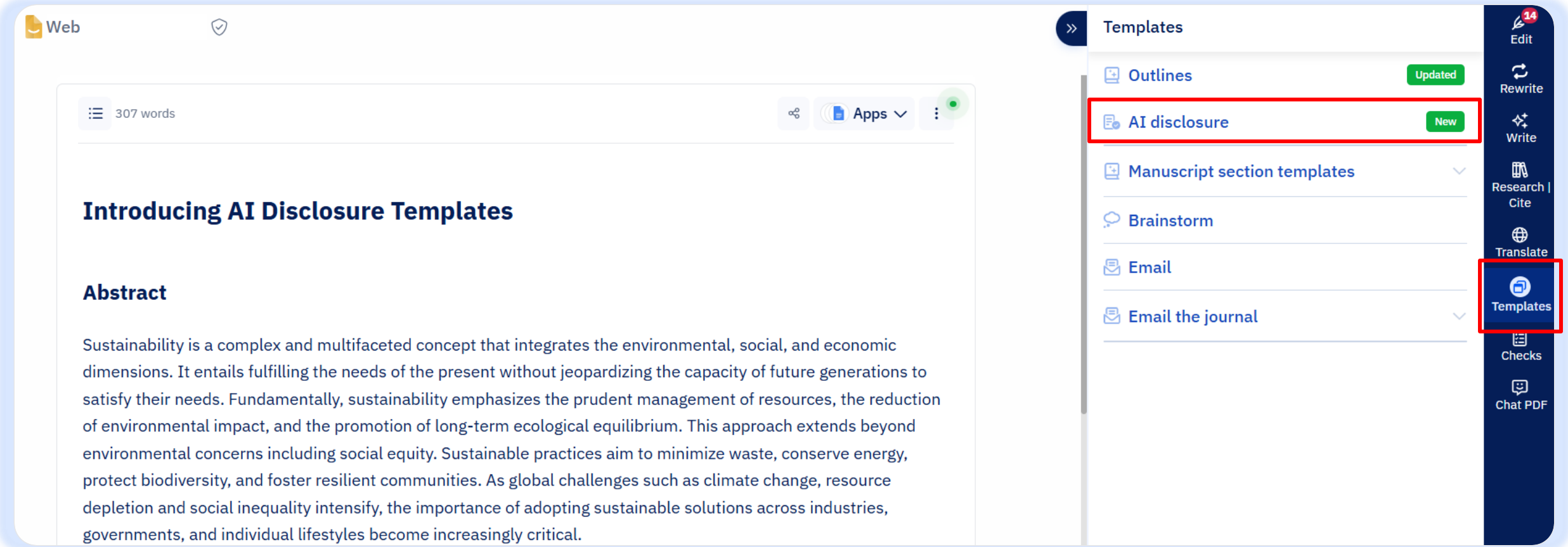

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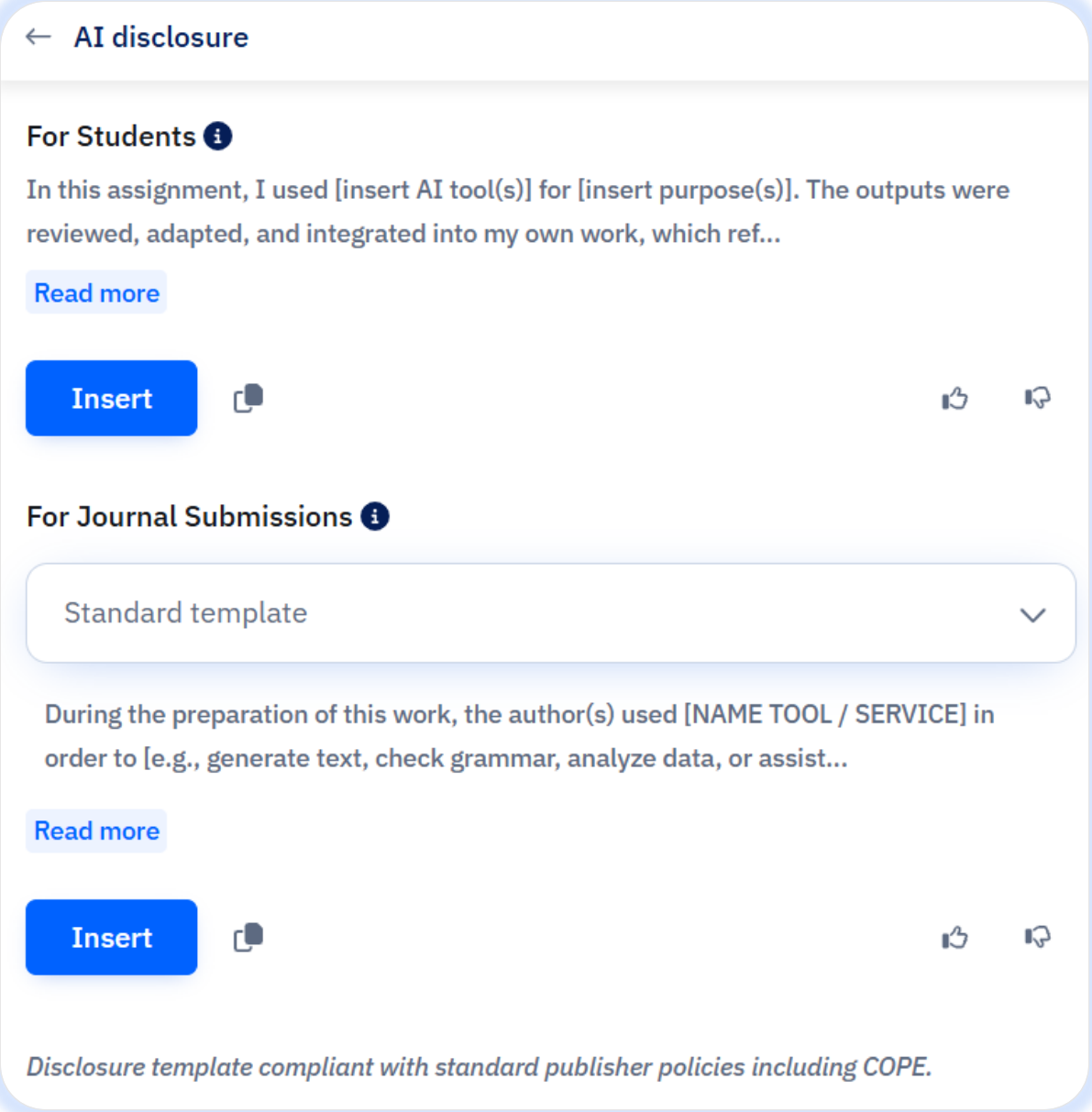
- **Student-ready Templates**: Ideal for coursework, essays, or theses. Expand to read, review, and customize statements.
- **Journal-specific Templates**: Standard, COPE-aligned, or publisher-specific disclosures with direct links to policies for verification.
- **Easy Insertion**: Place AI disclosures exactly where needed: Acknowledgments, Methods, or a dedicated Compliance section, with a single click.
- **Customizable Statements**: Indicate how AI helped your writing, the tool used, and the purpose. Tailor disclosures to reflect your work accurately.



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← AI disclosure

For Students

In this assignment, I used [insert AI tool(s)] for [insert purpose(s)]. The outputs were reviewed, adapted, and integrated into my own work, which reflects my personal understanding and complies with the academic integrity policies of my institution.

Purposes (add as relevant)

Idea support (brainstorming, outlining, concept breakdown)

Writing support (drafting from notes, drafting from scratch)

Editing support (grammar, paraphrasing, clarity, tone, organization)

Research support (citations, references, summaries)

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Standard template

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- American Chemical Society (ACS)
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- Cambridge University Press
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- Frontiers

For Journal Submissions

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Apps

environmental concerns including social equity. Sustainable practices aim to minimize waste, conserve energy, protect biodiversity, and foster resilient communities. As global challenges such as climate change, resource depletion and social inequality intensify, the importance of adopting sustainable solutions across industries, governments, and individual lifestyles become increasingly critical.

Introduction

Sustainability has emerged as a pivotal concept in addressing the multifaceted challenges facing contemporary society. It encompasses the balanced integration of environmental stewardship, social equity, and economic viability to ensure the well-being of both current and future generations. As global pressures such as climate change, resource scarcity, and social disparities escalate, the imperative to adopt sustainable practices becomes increasingly urgent across all sectors. This paper explores the core principles of sustainability, emphasizing the prudent management of resources, reduction of environmental impact, and the promotion of long-term ecological and social resilience.

Disclosure of AI usage

In this assignment, I used [insert AI tool(s)] for [insert purpose(s)]. The outputs were reviewed, adapted, and integrated into my own work, which reflects my personal understanding and complies with the academic integrity policies of my institution.

AI disclosure

For Students

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Idea support (brainstorming, outlining, concept breakdown)

Writing support (drafting from notes, drafting from scratch)

Editing support (grammar, paraphrasing, clarity, tone, organization)

Research support (citations, references, summaries)

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Disclosure of AI usage

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Plagiarism in the AI Era

Traditional Plagiarism still applies
Copying without attribution, paraphrasing too closely without citation, self-plagiarism across publications - These rules do not change with AI

AI-Specific Plagiarism risks
Over reliance on AI paraphrasing without understanding, lack of proper source attribution when AI synthesizes information, using others' ideas through AI rewording

Practical Prevention Strategies

Practical Prevention Strategies

1. **The "Explain It" Test**
   If you cannot explain every claim in your writing without looking at the AI output, you don't understand it well enough. Rewrite it in your own words before including it.

2. **Source-First, AI-Second**
   AI tools can help streamline literature discovery and suggest relevant citations, but scholarly rigor requires independently reviewing and validating every reference thoroughly.

3. **Track Your AI Interactions**
   Keep a simple log of what AI tools you used, what prompts you gave, and how you modified the output. This makes disclosure easy and protects you if questions arise later.

Plagiarism Check

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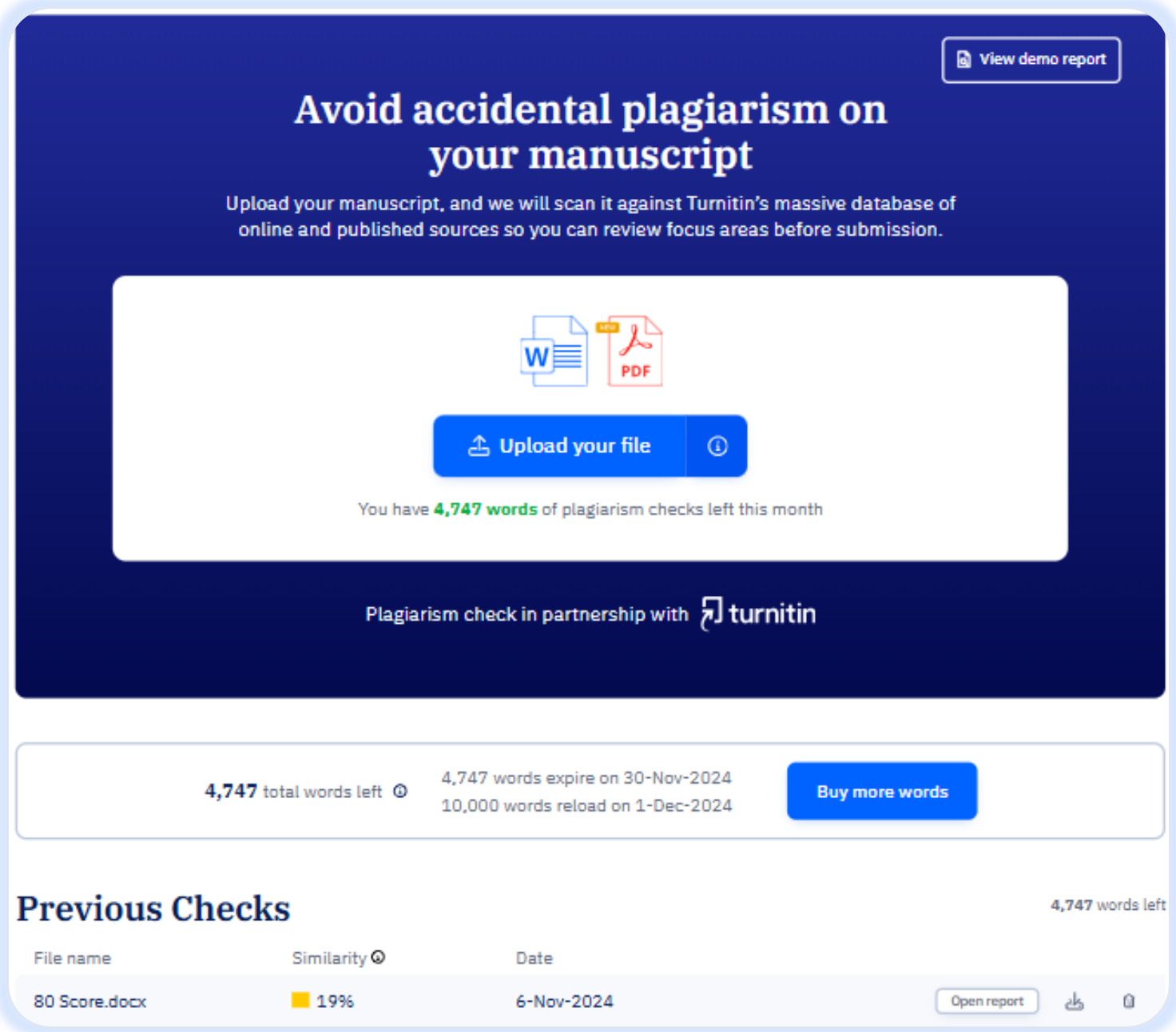

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Efficacy of Telemedicine: A Comprehensive Analysis

Abstract:

Telemedicine has emerged as a pivotal tool in the healthcare industry, revolutionizing the way medical services are provided. This paper aims to explore the efficacy of telemedicine by examining its benefits, challenges, and impact on healthcare professionals and patients. The study employs user interviews and surveys with healthcare professionals to gather insights into their experiences and perceptions of telemedicine. Additionally, renowned authors in the field of telemedicine are cited to provide a comprehensive understanding of the subject. The findings highlight the positive impact of telemedicine on healthcare delivery, patient outcomes, accessibility, and cost-effectiveness. The paper concludes by emphasizing the importance of continued research, technological advancements, and policy support to further enhance the efficacy of telemedicine.

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monitoring, electronic health records, and n. By leveraging advancements in communication technology, telemedicine has the potential to overcome geographical barriers, improve access to healthcare, and enhance patient outcomes.

The adoption of telemedicine has gained significant attention in recent years due to its ability to address various healthcare challenges. In many regions, particularly in rural and underserved areas, access to healthcare facilities and specialized medical expertise is limited. Telemedicine offers a promising solution by providing remote access to healthcare services, bridging the gap between patients and healthcare providers. It enables patients to receive timely medical consultations, diagnostic evaluations, and treatment recommendations from the comfort of their own homes.

Furthermore, telemedicine has demonstrated positive impacts on patient outcomes. Studies have shown that telemedicine interventions can reduce hospital readmission rates, improve chronic disease management, enhance medication adherence, and promote preventive care. By facilitating continuous remote monitoring and timely interventions, telemedicine contributes to better disease management, particularly for patients with chronic conditions.

Additionally, telemedicine has the potential to enhance healthcare equity. It helps overcome geographical barriers and reduces disparities in access to specialized care. Patients residing in remote or underserved areas can benefit from expert consultations and healthcare services that were previously inaccessible. Telemedicine also enables healthcare professionals to reach populations that tion challenges, such as elderly individuals or individuals with

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healthcare. As the demand for virtual care continues to grow, we can expect to see even more innovation in this space. Virtual care is poised to revolutionise the way healthcare is delivered, and it **has the potential to improve access to** care, reduce costs, **and** improve **patient outcomes**. Here are some notable trends that are likely to influence the future of virtual care: Expansion of Remote Monitoring: Remote patient monitoring (RPM) allows healthcare providers to collect patien

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Using AI without losing your voice: Practical workflow strategies

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Using AI Without Losing Your Voice

Write First, Polish Later
Always draft your ideas in your own words first. Use AI only to refine grammar, clarity, or structure. Never to generate your arguments or analysis from scratch.

Treat AI as a Research Assistant, Not a Co-Author
Use AI for mechanical tasks: summarising papers, checking grammar, organising references, brainstorming structures. The intellectual contribution (your thesis, your critique, your synthesis) must remain yours.

Edit AI Suggestions, Don't Accept Them Blindly
Every AI output should be reviewed, revised, and rewritten in your own voice. If the final text sounds nothing like you, your reader, and your examiner, will notice.

AI Footprint

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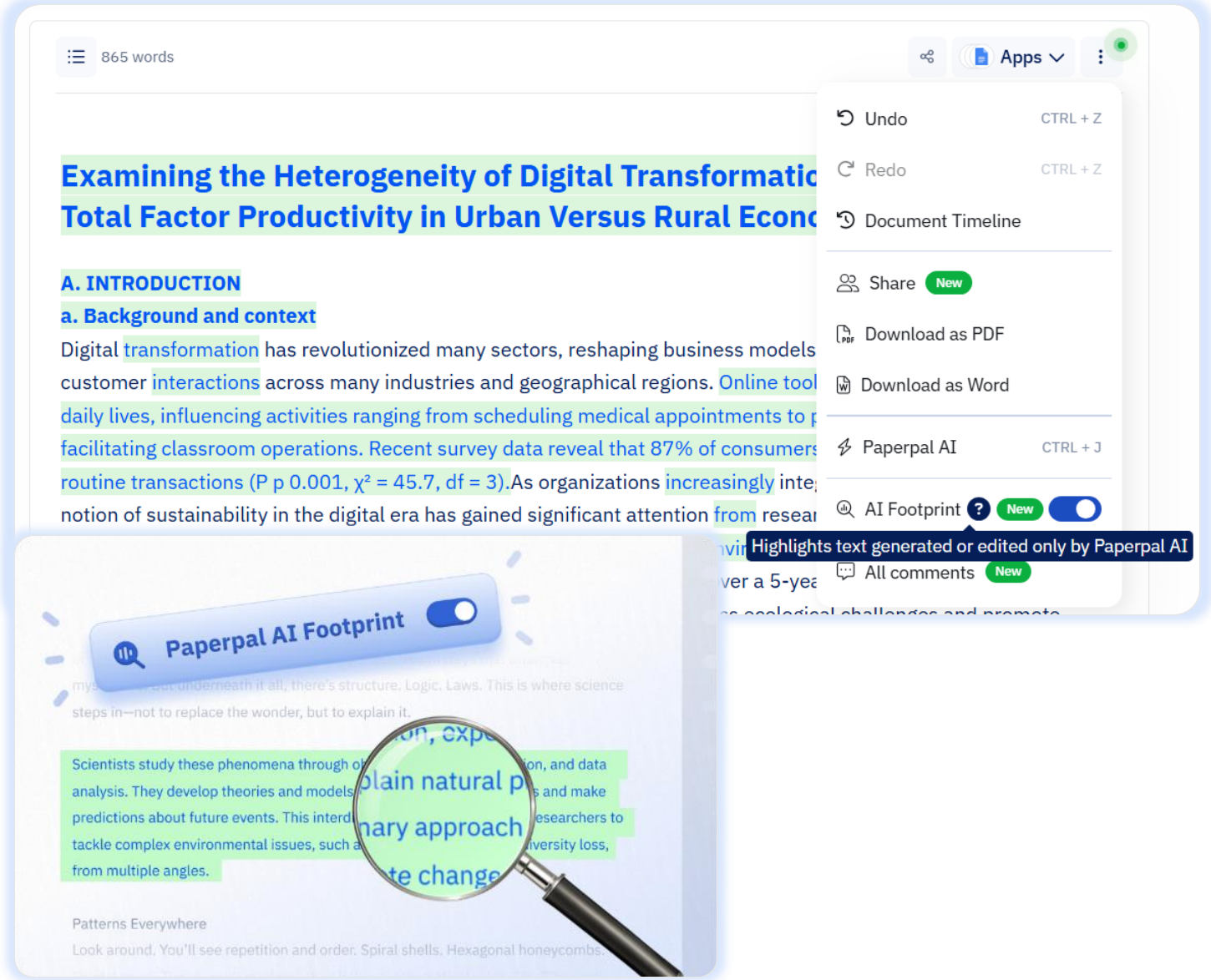
Paperpal AI Footprint is a real-time feature available on Web that helps you see where Paperpal AI assisted you instantly, so you maintain full control over your authorship and writing process.

- **Stay in Control:** Clearly see where Paperpal AI has suggested or rewritten, helping you own your writing.
- **Save Time:** Quickly review AI changes without manual re-checking.
- **Maintain Transparency:** Prepare confidently for compliance and disclosure requirements.
- **Make It Your Own:** Edit AI suggestions to transform them into your personal voice, the highlights vanish as you revise.



Dos and Don’ts for AI transparency

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Dos

- Disclose every AI tool used and describe how it assisted your work
- Verify all AI-generated content, especially references and data
- Maintain your original voice. Rewrite AI suggestions in your own words
- Check your publisher's and institution's specific AI use policies before submission

Don’ts

- List AI as a co-author on any publication or submission
- Copy-paste AI-generated text without reviewing, editing, and rewriting
- Assume AI paraphrasing removes the need to cite original sources
- Hide or downplay your use of AI. Transparency builds trust, secrecy destroys it

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Professor Emmanuel Tsekleves
Lancaster University

Prof Emmanuel Tsekleves
Professor at Lancaster University
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Q&A Time

We'll answer as many questions as possible from the Q&A box!

Thank You!

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